Extending WireChat Components

In addition to view level tweaks, you may want to add new features or override certain behaviors in the underlying Livewire components for instance, adding a method to retrieve chat analytics, or injecting custom business logic when a new conversation starts.

Why Extend Components Instead of Editing the Package?

When you edit the package's core files, upgrading to the latest version can become risky. Extending WireChat components in your own namespace prevents conflicts and keeps your custom changes safe during package updates.

Example: Overriding the `Chats` Component

Suppose you want an extra method called **`test()`**, which logs a special message whenever a user clicks a button in the chat list.

1. Create Your Custom Component

Use Laravel's artisan command to scaffold a new Livewire component:

```
php artisan make:livewire Chats --inline
```

This will generate a file under your **`app/Livewire`** directory (adjust the namespace or path as needed).

2. Extend the Base Chats Component

Open your newly created component and have it extend the Chats base class. In this example, we're extending **`Wirechat\Wirechat\Livewire\Chats\Chats`**: